

UNCLASSIFIED // OSINT

Turkmenistan Military Capability Report

Quantitative Core + Qualitative Assessment

Prepared: 07 Apr 2026

Scope: Structure, equipment, missiles, UAS, procurement, intent

Length target: Extended analytical edition

TURKMENISTAN MILITARY CAPABILITY REPORT

Quantitative Core + Qualitative Assessment (OSINT)

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Date: 07 Apr 2026

Country: Turkmenistan

Prepared by: Open-source synthesis

Report scope: Armed forces structure, order of battle, equipment inventories, missile/UAS capabilities, military spending, procurement trends, and intent assessment.

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1) Executive Snapshot

Turkmenistan fields a medium-size military for the region with a force design centered on:

- border and internal security,
- territorial defense with Soviet legacy systems,
- selective modernization in air defense, unmanned systems, and Caspian naval strike assets.

Topline quantitative snapshot

Metric	Value	Source
Active armed forces	35,000-36,500	[S3][S8]
Active + paramilitary	~40,000	[S1]
GDP (current US\$)	\$51.387B (2024)	[S2]

Metric	Value	Source
Defense budget	\$1.463B (GFP 2026 estimate)	[S1]
Defense/GDP (calculated)	2.85%	[S1][S2]
Tanks	654-702	[S1][S3][S4]
Total aircraft	91-92	[S1][S5]
Naval major total assets	16 (GFP baseline)	[S1]
GFP rank	78 / 145	[S1]

Condensed qualitative judgement

- **Primary mission logic:** regime stability, border control (especially Afghanistan-facing vectors), and Caspian maritime denial/protection.
- **Modernization pattern:** not broad force transformation; instead targeted acquisitions in drones, SAM layers, naval missiles, and selected armored/mobility upgrades.
- **Operational center of gravity:** surveillance + deterrence-by-presence rather than expeditionary warfare.

2) Source Method and Confidence

2.1 Source treatment

This report deliberately combines:

1. **Structured annual datasets** (for top-level comparables and macro totals),
2. **Reference aggregators** (for branch and equipment detail),
3. **Specialist reporting** (for UAS and procurement trajectories),
4. **Archive/mirror data** (for historical or inaccessible primary pages).

2.2 Confidence tiers used in this report

Tier	Meaning	Typical use in this report
Tier A	Structured institutional data with stable methodology	GDP, population, top-level manpower and budget baselines
Tier B	Strong open-source references with partial uncertainty	Branch force structures, equipment families, historical deliveries
Tier C	Secondary reporting or single-source claims	Certain launcher counts, system-specific fit-outs, opaque procurement lines

2.3 Known data frictions

- Personnel split differs between sources (for example, 33k/3k/0.5k versus 30k/4k/1k branch allocations).

- Naval counts vary depending on whether patrol craft only or full combat/auxiliary fleet is counted.
- Some missile and SAM counts are type-confirmed but quantity-uncertain.
- Several sources mix "in inventory", "displayed", and "operational" categories.

3) National and Economic Baseline

3.1 Demography and economy

Indicator	Value	Year	Source
Population	7,494,498	2024	[S2]
GDP (current US\$)	\$51,387,209,872	2024	[S2]
GDP per capita (calc)	\$6,856	2024	[S2]
GDP (PPP)	\$134.555B	2026 est.	[S1]
Foreign exchange/gold reserves	\$21.074B	2026 est.	[S1]

3.2 Energy and strategic resource context (military relevance)

Indicator	Value	Source
Proven natural gas reserves	11.327 trillion cu.m	[S1]
Natural gas production	86.472 billion cu.m	[S1]
Oil production	272,000 bbl/day	[S1]
Oil proven reserves	600 million bbl	[S1]

Assessment: Hydrocarbon infrastructure security is a major force-planning driver, especially around the Caspian and key inland transport corridors.

4) Defense Spending and Financial Capacity

4.1 Spending baselines

Metric	Value	Source note
Defense budget	\$1.463B	GFP 2026 estimated budget [S1]
GDP	\$51.387B	World Bank API latest [S2]
Defense burden	2.85% of GDP (calc)	Derived from above
Defense spending per capita	\$195 (calc)	Derived from above

4.2 Historical burden references

Metric	Value	Source
Military expenditures	1.9% of GDP (2019 est.)	CIA-mirror profile [S8]
Military expenditures	1.8% (2018, 2017, 2016 est.)	CIA-mirror profile [S8]
Military expenditures	1.5% of GDP (2015 est.)	CIA-mirror profile [S8]

Interpretation: Depending on source model, current burden appears in the ~1.8%-2.9% band. The higher estimate reflects GFP budget assumptions; the lower values reflect CIA-mirror historical estimates.

5) Force Structure and Personnel

5.1 Armed services and security components

Turkmenistan military/security architecture includes:

- Ground Forces,
- Air Force and Air Defense Forces,
- Naval Forces,
- Border service and internal troops (parallel security roles). [S3][S8]

5.2 Personnel by source

Personnel metric	Estimate	Source
Active armed forces (total)	36,500	[S1][S3]
Active armed forces (alternate)	35,000	[S8]
Army	33,000 (alt: 30,000)	[S3][S8]
Air and Air Defense	3,000 (alt: 4,000)	[S3][S8]
Navy	500 (alt: 1,000)	[S3][S8]
Paramilitary	3,500	[S1]
Reserve	0 (reported)	[S1]

5.3 Conscription and service model

Item	Reported value	Source
Draft age	18-27 (male compulsory)	[S8]
Standard service length	24 months	[S3][S8]
Navy service length (reported variant)	30 months	[S8]

5.4 Territorial organization

- 5 military districts: Ahal, Balkan, Dashoguz, Lebap, Mary. [S3][S4]

6) Ground Forces (Army)

6.1 Reported organizational core

Formation	Reported structure elements	Source
2nd Training Motor Rifle Division	1 tank regt, 1 motor rifle regt, 1 artillery regt	[S4]
3rd Motor Rifle Division	1 tank regt, 3 motor rifle regts, 1 artillery regt	[S4]
11th Motor Rifle Division	1 tank regt, 1 motor rifle regt, 1 artillery regt	[S4]
22nd Motor Rifle Division	1 tank regt, 1 motor rifle regt, 1 artillery regt	[S4]
Additional units (reported)	SF regt, rocket/artillery/AT/engineer brigades, SAM brigades	[S4]

6.2 Ground forces aggregate strength indicators

Category	Count	Source
Tanks	654 (alt: ~700)	[S1][S3]
Armored vehicles (broad, GFP)	11,588	[S1]
Self-propelled artillery	73	[S1]
Towed artillery	457	[S1]
MLRS	164	[S1]

6.3 Detailed armor and mechanized inventory (selected)

Type	Reported count	Notes
T-72UMG / T-72 family	650-702	Source variance [S3][S4]
T-90S	4-10	Small modern supplement [S3][S4]
BRDM-2	200	Recon vehicle [S4]
BRM-1	60	Recon vehicle [S4]
BMP-series (combined entries)	1,038+	BMP-1/BMP-2/BMP-3 mixed counts [S4]

Type	Reported count	Notes
BTR-60	120	APC [S4]
BTR-70	300	APC [S4]
BTR-80	450	APC [S4]
Lazar-3	~24 ordered (delivery phased)	Reported acquisition track [S4]

6.4 Detailed artillery and ground missile inventory (selected)

Category	Type	Reported count	Notes
SRBM	9K72 Elbrus (Scud-class legacy)	16	Operational status uncertain [S4]
MLRS	122mm systems (incl. BM-21 family)	92	[S4]
MLRS	RM-70	6	[S4]
MLRS	BM-27 Uragan	60	[S4]
MLRS	BM-30 Smerch	6	[S4]
SP artillery	2S3 Akatsiya	16	Some status uncertainty [S4]
SP artillery	2S1 Gvozdika	40	[S4]
SP mortar	2S9 Nona	17	[S4]
Towed artillery	D-30	350	[S4]
Towed artillery	D-20	72	[S4]
Towed artillery	Other listed towed guns/mortars	132+	M-46, D-1, 2A36, 2A65, mortars [S4]

6.5 Ground-based air defense systems (type-confirmed)

Reported families include:

- S-125 variants (including upgraded forms),
- S-200,
- 2K11 Krug,
- 2K12 Kub,
- 9K33 Osa,
- 9K35 Strela-10,
- FM-90 / KS-1A / FD-2000-family reporting in some sources. [S3][S4][S5][S10]

Note: Open sources are stronger on **system presence** than validated launcher/battery counts.

6.6 Qualitative note - Army

The army remains heavy in Soviet-derived mass and tube/rocket fires, with modernization concentrated in selected nodes (some armor upgrades, mobility platforms, anti-armor

systems, and possible SAM modernization). Its force utility is highest for territorial defense and state control missions rather than rapid expeditionary campaigning.

7) Air Force and Integrated Air Defense

7.1 Personnel and top-level force data

Metric	Value	Source
Air force personnel	3,000 (alt estimate 4,000 with Air Defense)	[S3][S8]
Total aircraft	91-92	[S1][S5]
Fighters	22	[S1]
Attack fixed-wing	27	[S1]
Transport fixed-wing	5	[S1]
Trainers	11	[S1]
Helicopters total	26	[S1]
Attack helicopters	10	[S1]

7.2 Main reported aircraft/helicopter types

Role	Reported types
Fighter	MiG-29 / MiG-29UB
Attack (fixed-wing)	Su-25 (legacy backbone), plus reported newer light-attack/trainer types in some listings
Transport	An-26, An-74, C-27J (reported)
Utility helicopter	Mi-8 / Mi-17, AW109 (reported)
Attack helicopter	Mi-24

7.3 Bases and major units (reported)

Site / Unit	Function
Mary-2 / 99th Aviation Base	Fighter and strike aviation hub
Ak-Tepe (Ashgabat area)	Mixed aviation and support elements
1st AA Missile Regiment (reported)	Legacy area air defense component
2nd Radio-Technical Brigade	Radar and airspace surveillance functions

7.4 Integrated air defense and SAM inventory (families)

Layer	Reported systems	Confidence
Long-range legacy	S-200	Medium
Medium legacy	S-125 family, 2K12 Kub, 2K11 Krug	Medium
Mobile short/medium	Osa, Strela-10	Medium
Modernized/imported (reported)	FM-90, KS-1A, FD-2000-related reporting	Low-Medium
Point defense (naval-linked)	VL MICA, Mistral/SIMBAD RC on selected hulls	Medium

7.5 Qualitative note - Air and Air Defense

Air power remains mixed: aging Soviet tactical aircraft plus selective newer procurement and significant emphasis on layered air defense. The air defense network appears to be a strategic modernization priority because it supports both national sovereignty signaling and regime-security infrastructure defense.

8) Naval Forces (Caspian)

8.1 Core structure

Item	Reported value	Source
Navy personnel	500-2,000 (source spread)	[S3][S6][S8]
Basing	Turkmenbasy naval base complex	[S6]
Naval infantry	Separate brigade reported	[S6]

8.2 Fleet composition snapshots

Source framing	Topline count	Notes
GFP baseline	16 total assets / 16 patrol vessels	[S1]
Branch-level references	Includes patrol craft, missile boats, corvette, auxiliaries	[S6][S12]

8.3 Missile and major weapons by naval platform (reported)

Platform / class	Reported weapon fit	Capability relevance
Deniz Han corvette (C-92 class)	8x Otomat Mk2 AShM, 16-cell VL MICA, 76mm gun, CIWS, ASW rockets/torpedo tubes	First modern multi-role flagship with AAW + ASuW profile

Platform / class	Reported weapon fit	Capability relevance
Project 12418 Molniya boats	Kh-35 Uran-E anti-ship missile fit reported	High-value littoral anti-surface strike
FAC-33 / Dearsan-derived units	Marte/Otomat family reporting	Fast missile attack in Caspian littoral
Patrol craft classes	gun-armed, some missile-capable variants	Maritime policing + layered denial

8.4 Qualitative note - Navy

Turkmen naval development is selective but meaningful: the force is still coastal and regional, yet it has shifted from patrol-only toward missile-armed deterrence. This aligns with energy infrastructure protection and maritime sovereignty signaling in the Caspian.

9) Missile, Strike, and Standoff Capabilities

9.1 Anti-ship missile (AShM) portfolio (reported types)

Family	Platform context
Kh-35 Uran-E	Molniya missile boats
Otomat Mk2	Deniz Han corvette
Marte Mk2 / Marte 2N	Reported on select Turkish-built missile craft

9.2 Surface-to-air missile (SAM) portfolio (reported families)

Segment	Systems
Legacy strategic/area	S-200, S-125 variants
Legacy maneuver support	2K11 Krug, 2K12 Kub
Mobile short-range	Osa, Strela-10
Modernized/imported claims	FM-90, KS-1A, FD-2000-related reporting
Naval SAM	VL MICA, SIMBAD RC (Mistral family)

9.3 Ground strike missile indicators

System	Reported status
9K72 Elbrus (Scud-class legacy)	Reported in some listings; current operability uncertain

Assessment: Missile posture is strongest in **air defense and littoral anti-ship strike**, weaker in clearly validated land-attack precision strike depth.

10) Unmanned Systems and Counter-UAS

Turkmenistan is one of the more active UAV adopters in Central Asia, with surveillance, UCAV, loitering, and domestic assembly lines all present in open reporting.

10.1 Surveillance UAVs (reported)

Type	Role	Reported notes
Orbiter 2B	Tactical ISR	In service; Israeli origin
Elbit Skylark	Tactical ISR	In service; reportedly used with mine-laying support context
Falco XN	MALE-class ISR	Delivered in 2011; important endurance platform
Busel M / Busel M40	ISR	Belarus-linked, locally assembled variants reported
ScanEagle 2	ISR (including naval use)	Reported in service from 2022
ZALA 421-series	ISR/counterterror context	Reported/proposed, confirmation mixed

10.2 UCAV and armed UAV systems (reported)

Type	Reported armament	Military relevance
CH-3A	AR-1 missiles (about 10 km class)	Introduces armed ISR-strike loop
WJ-600A/D	CM-502KG missiles (20 km+ class)	Stand-off attack profile
Bayraktar TB2	MAM-L / MAM-C PGMs	Precision strike + persistent ISR
Busel MB2	Small bombs/grenade payloads	Lower-end local UCAV capability

10.3 Loitering munitions and related systems

Type	Reported status
SkyStriker	In service (reported)
Busel MB1	Mentioned in reporting; confirmation weaker

10.4 Counter-UAS and EW (reported)

Capability area	Reported examples
Counter-UAS sensors	Radar/EO anti-drone suites shown in official settings

Capability area	Reported examples
Communications/EW	Rohde and Schwarz jamming systems reported
Layered anti-air defense tie-in	SAM modernization linked to C-UAS defensive logic

10.5 Qualitative note - UAS enterprise

The UAV portfolio is not symbolic; it is operationally relevant and diversified across reconnaissance, strike, and maritime support use cases. It also carries domestic surveillance utility in a tightly controlled security environment.

11) Procurement Trends and Supplier Network

11.1 Supplier diversification

SIPRI-referenced public reporting for 2012-2016 indicates a non-traditional mix:

- Turkey: 36%
 - China: 27%
 - Russia: 20%
- [S9]

This marks a diversification away from exclusive Soviet/Russian dependency.

11.2 Reported procurement timeline (selected)

Year / period	Reported development
2009-2011	Naval modernization starts; Project 12418 missile boats delivered
2011	Falco XN UAV deliveries reported
2013-2015	Belarus-linked UAV production arrangements and local center development
2015-2016	Expansion of Chinese UCAV/target-drone families reported
2016 onward	Additional SAM modernization reporting appears in open sources
2021	Bayraktar TB2 and SkyStriker reporting; Deniz Han corvette commissioned
2022	ScanEagle 2 linked to naval deployment reporting

11.3 Procurement priorities inferred from pattern

1. **Border ISR and rapid strike response** (UAV-heavy investments)
2. **Layered air defense hardening** (legacy retention + selective import)
3. **Caspian anti-ship deterrence** (missile-armed fleet core)
4. **Political diversification of suppliers** (Turkey/China plus legacy Russian systems)

5. **Selective domestic assembly** (limited but symbolically important industrial capacity)

12) Intent, Objectives, and Force Employment Logic

12.1 Strategic intent indicators

- Official neutrality policy remains central to state messaging.
- Force structure and basing show persistent prioritization of domestic stability and border integrity.
- Procurement choices indicate concern with:
 - Afghan-border spillover risks,
 - strategic site protection,
 - Caspian maritime competition and infrastructure security,
 - internal surveillance/control support functions.

12.2 Practical military objectives (inferred)

1. **Deter limited external pressure** without alliance dependence.
2. **Maintain high domestic coercive reliability** across military-security apparatus.
3. **Control littoral operating space** around critical offshore/onshore energy nodes.
4. **Preserve regime autonomy** via multi-vector suppliers and non-allied posture.

12.3 Employment profile by mission type

Mission type	Relative capability
Border security and reinforcement	High
Internal security support	High
Caspian patrol and limited sea denial	Medium-High
Sustained modern high-intensity joint warfighting	Medium-Low
Expeditionary operations far from home	Low

13) Outlook (2026-2030)

13.1 Most likely capability trajectory

- Incremental upgrades, not force-wide recapitalization.
- Continued UAV and counter-UAS investment.
- Further naval quality improvements over quantity.
- Ongoing SAM/IADS refresh to keep mixed old-new architecture viable.

13.2 Key structural constraints

- Maintenance burden from mixed-origin inventories.
- Limited transparency on readiness and munitions stocks.
- Training and sustainment depth likely uneven across units.

- High dependence on imported technology for higher-end systems.

13.3 Net assessment

Turkmenistan is building a **defensive-control military toolkit**: enough to monitor, deter, and punish localized threats, but not optimized for long-duration high-end combined-arms campaigns against major powers.

14) Annex A - Consolidated Numbers Tables

A1. Personnel comparison table

Metric	Estimate A	Estimate B	Notes
Active total	36,500	35,000	Source-year variance
Army	33,000	30,000	Branch split variance
Air and Air Defense	3,000	4,000	Branch split variance
Navy	500	1,000	Branch split variance
Paramilitary	3,500	n/a	Not always separately listed

A2. Ground combat systems (selected)

Segment	Count
Tanks	654-702
SP artillery	73
Towed artillery	457 (GFP baseline)
MLRS	164
BRDM-2	200
BRM-1	60
BTR-60/70/80 combined	870
Major BMP-family entries listed	1,038+

A3. Air systems

Segment	Count
Total aircraft	91-92
Fighters	22
Attack fixed-wing	27
Transports (fixed-wing)	5

Segment	Count
Trainers	11
Helicopters	26
Attack helicopters	10

A4. Naval systems

Segment	Count / status
GFP naval total assets	16
GFP patrol vessels	16
Corvette program	At least 1 modern corvette commissioned
Missile boats	Present (Molniya and Turkish-built classes reported)
Submarines	0 reported

A5. Missile and UAS capability ledger (type-level)

Category	Type families
AShM	Kh-35, Otomat Mk2, Marte Mk2
SAM (land/naval)	S-200, S-125 family, Kub, Krug, Osa, Strela-10, FM-90, KS-1A, FD-2000-related reporting, VL MICA, SIMBAD RC
UCAV	CH-3A, WJ-600A/D, Bayraktar TB2, Busel MB2
Loitering munition	SkyStriker (reported), MB1 (weaker confirmation)
ISR UAV	Orbiter 2B, Skylark, Falco XN, Busel M/M40, ScanEagle 2

15) Annex B - Source Register

Source key

- **[S1]** Global Firepower, Turkmenistan 2026 profile
- **[S2]** World Bank API indicators (GDP/population latest pull)
- **[S3]** Wikipedia: Armed Forces of Turkmenistan
- **[S4]** Wikipedia: Turkmen Ground Forces + equipment list pages
- **[S5]** Wikipedia: Turkmen Air Force
- **[S6]** Wikipedia: Turkmen Naval Forces
- **[S7]** Oryx: Turkmenistan drone capability reporting
- **[S8]** CIA World Factbook mirror page (Theodora, 2024 data snapshot)
- **[S9]** Eurasianet report citing SIPRI transfer shares

- **[S10]** Open-source reporting on FD-2000/KS-1A/FM-90-type claims
- **[S11]** FlightGlobal World Air Forces directory references
- **[S12]** Naval reporting (Naval News / open naval defense publications)

Reliability notes

1. World Bank indicators are high-confidence for macroeconomics.
2. GFP is useful for standardized comparison but includes estimated values.
3. Wikipedia pages are used as aggregation indexes and are cross-checked where possible.
4. Oryx provides strong visual OSINT in UAV domains but may not publish complete counts.
5. Some missile and naval fit details remain low-to-medium confidence due to contradictory public reporting.

Endnote

This report is designed as a reusable country template: quantitative-first tables, explicit uncertainty labeling, and limited but decision-useful qualitative interpretation.